CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

AIRBNB CO-HOST / STR MANAGER IN THE AI ERA

Pricing algorithms fill calendars. Guests still review the human stuff: clean, fast, kind, local.

★ TL;DR — Around ~$75K on the site's scale for a co-host with a solid portfolio, startable in 1–6 months with no license in most places. The catch: you earn a percentage of other people's revenue — no properties, no income. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

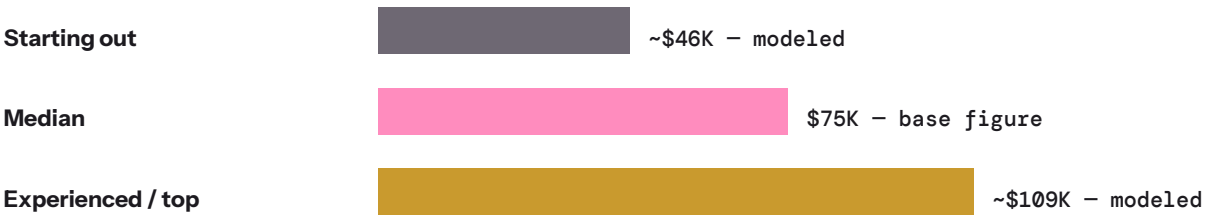
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- Co-hosts earn a cut of booking revenue for running everything.
- Fully remote-capable — except the local cleaner and inspector network you manage.
- AI prices and messages well; reviews are won by operations, not software.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Airbnb Co-host / STR Manager is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A AIRBNB CO-HOST / STR MANAGER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Set up listings: photos, copy, pricing and house rules
- ✓ Message guests; handle check-ins and problems
- ✓ Coordinate cleaners and maintenance between stays
- ✓ Track performance and report earnings to owners

Think: a hotel GM whose hotel is scattered across other people's houses.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Dynamic pricing, automated guest messaging and review requests run much of the desk. Smart locks and noise sensors automate the building basics.	Choosing which owners to work with, rescuing a bad stay in real time, and quality-controlling cleaners — judgment and local presence win the reviews that rank listings.

⚠ **Platform policy and local short-term-rental rules can change your income overnight; depending on one platform is a real risk.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Run it from a laptop; scale by adding doors, not hours ✓ Percentage pay rises automatically with good performance ✓ Guests are mostly on holiday — good energy	✗ Guest problems land at check-in time: evenings and weekends ✗ A cleaner no-show becomes your emergency ✗ Slow seasons cut revenue you don't control

Good fit? Hospitality-minded, systems-tidy, and calm inside guest drama.
Bad fit? You hate messaging strangers or being on call at dinner time.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — CO-HOST FOR ONE OWNER FIRST	DOOR B — JOIN AN STR MANAGEMENT COMPANY
Manage a single property for a friend or local investor, prove the revenue and the reviews, then use that case study to win more doors. Most co-hosts grow owner by owner.	Established vacation-rental firms hire operations and guest-relations staff. You learn pricing, tools and vendor management fast — then decide whether to stay or build your own book.

Smart move: Audit before you pitch: walk an owner's listing, show the gaps (photos, pricing, response time), and let the audit be the sales pitch.

Where you land after: A portfolio of a dozen-plus doors → a boutique STR management brand with staff.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	GET ONE	BUILD THE	AUTOMATE THE	PROVE AND	ADD DOORS

STEP 1 — Learn the platform game

FREE · TODAY

- Study top listings in one market: photos, pricing, reviews, response patterns.
- Learn the local short-term-rental rules for anywhere you'll operate.

STEP 2 — Get one property

MONTHS 1-2

- Pitch one owner with a concrete improvement plan for their listing.
- Agree the split, the duties and the cleaner budget in writing.

STEP 3 — Build the operation

WEEKS

- Cleaner and handyman bench, smart lock, supplies checklist, inspection routine.
- Your cleaners are your quality department — pay and treat them accordingly.

STEP 4 — Automate the desk

MONTH 2

- A pricing tool, message templates and a synced calendar.
- Automate routine messages; personally handle anything emotional.

STEP 5 — Prove and publish results

MONTHS 2-4

- Track occupancy and revenue against the owner's previous setup.
- Turn the improvement into a one-page case study.

STEP 6 — Add doors carefully

MONTH 4+

- Take owners in the same areas your cleaners already cover.
- Say no to bad properties — reviews follow the manager, not just the home.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: audit three live listings and write down what's broken in each.
- □ Days 1–30: first owner pitched with a written plan; cleaner bench forming.
- □ Days 31–60: first listing relaunched with new photos, pricing and systems.

□ Days 61–90: reviews improving; case study drafted; second owner pitched.

□ Day 90: one proven property live — the case study is now your sales engine.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ FIVE STARS IS A SYSTEM. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.